TRADING JOURNAL

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Trade log — July 2026

MGC · MNQ — micro futures

$50,000 ACCOUNT · $100 MAX LOSS PER DAY

CONTENTS

TRADE 0001

MGC Micro Gold — Short

29 July 2026 · 01:45 – 01:50

BEFORE — AT ENTRY, 01:47

AFTER — 02:05

WHY I TOOK IT

Liquidity grab short. The 01:20 candle spiked to 4,030.30, took the liquidity above the highs, then closed straight back under the descending trendline off the 23:00 high. Shorted the retest at 4,022.

WHY I EXITED

Coming up on the 1-hour close and the 5-minute wasn't driving into it. Closed by hand rather than wait for the stop or target.

P&L **−$19.80**

NOTES

- Stop was never hit — price got no closer than 4,025.70.
- Target was hit about 15 minutes later, on the very next candle.
- Held to plan this was +$268.20.

TRADE 0002

MNQ Micro Nasdaq — Long

29 July 2026 · 23:12 – 23:15

BEFORE — AT ENTRY, 23:12

AFTER — PRICE THROUGH THE STOP

WHY I TOOK IT

Anticipating a morning star reversal on the 30-minute after the drop off 27,800. Entry was a buy stop above price at 27,600.25 — wanted the push to come to me rather than catching the knife.

WHY I EXITED

Closed by hand on the way through, above the stop, rather than wait to see if it held.

P&L **−$112.50**

NOTES

- Exited 7.75 points above the stop — price went on to trade through it.
- Getting out early saved roughly $31 compared to letting the stop hit.
- Dipped a further ~150 points before the reversal came, then ran well past target.

TRADE 0005

MGC Micro Gold — Short

30 July 2026 · 17:48 – 04:07

BEFORE — AT ENTRY, 17:48

AFTER — TARGET HIT, PRICE RUNNING PAST IT

WHY I TOOK IT

Aggressive entry off a 15m flip, taken in the last five minutes of that candle. Break/retest of the ascending trendline off the ~4,108 base — rally topped with a wick to ~4,167 that fell short of resistance, sharp red rejection, chop back up, then rolled back down through the trendline.

WHY I EXITED

Stop moved to break-even on a rule set before entry: if the next candle printed a new lower low, confirming continuation, move to break-even. It did. Price then came back and tagged the break-even stop.

P&L **−$2.60**

NOTES

- Fees only — classed as break-even, not a loss. Original stop (4,127.90) never touched.
- Target hit after the close, price ran to 4,100.30 — $175.00 left on the table.

LEFT ON THE TABLE

Not missed trades — trades that were taken and closed early. What each one actually made, against what holding to plan would have made.

HOLDING TO PLAN, ACROSS ALL CLOSED TRADES, WOULD HAVE NET

+$432.00 more

Trade 0001 — MGC Short

CLOSED	**−$19.80**
HELD TO PLAN	**+$268.20**
DIFFERENCE	**+$288.00** holding would have been better

Trade 0002 — MNQ Long

CLOSED	**−$112.50**
HELD TO PLAN	**−$143.50**
DIFFERENCE	**−$31.00** closing early was better

Trade 0005 — MGC Short

CLOSED	**−$2.60**
HELD TO PLAN	**+$172.40**
DIFFERENCE	**+$175.00** holding would have been better

SO FAR

Out early on three trades. Twice it cost money ($288.00, $175.00). Once it saved money ($31.00). 0005 followed a rule written before entry — proof a written rule isn't automatically the right one.

RUNNING TALLY

NET P&L

−$134.90

3 trades taken

RECORD

0–2–1

wins – losses – break-even

CHARGES PAID

$9.40

across three trades

PASSED / OBSERVED

1 / 1

0003 passed, saved $33.00 · 0004 observed, reference only

−$134.90 against a $100 max loss per day and ~$1,200 remaining on the $2,000 trailing drawdown. $432.00 left on the table across the three closed trades — see previous page. No conclusions drawn — this page updates as trades accumulate, reviewed properly at 20–50.